THE REPRIEVE

The three cases Adani fought in the US

CASE 1

THE CHARGE
Adani Group chairman Gautam Adani, nephew Sagar Adani, Adani Green Energy CEO Vneet S. Jaain and others allegedly bribed discom officials in four Indian states and a UT to execute sale agreements with Solar Energy Corporation of India between 2021 and '22. SECI would then buy power from Adani and Azure Power, an Indian solar firm that was listed then on the NYSE, to sell to the discoms

↘ Of the $265 mn alleged bribe, around $228 mn went to an unnamed high-ranking Andhra government official who facilitated the discom deal to buy 7,000 MW of power from SECI. This allegedly violated the Foreign Corrupt Practices Act that bars companies operating in the US from bribing foreign officials

The Closure
US Department of Justice dropped all criminal charges in the alleged graft case permanently. This was after the review failed to produce any substantiating evidence in the case

CASE 2

THE CHARGE
The US Securities and Exchange Commission alleged that Gautam and Sagar Adani had falsely touted Adani Green Energy's compliance with anti-bribery principles during the company's $750 mn bonds issue in the US. The bond offering had raised over $175 mn from US investors

↘ The offering materials of the bonds issue allegedly contained statements about its anti-corruption efforts that were materially false

The Closure
Without admitting or denying the allegations, Gautam and Sagar Adani agreed to pay $18 million to settle the case

CASE 3

THE CHARGE
Group flagship Adani Enterprises Ltd (AEL) had bought 35 shipments of LPG from a Dubai-based trader between Nov. '23 and Jun. '25, who purportedly supplied Iran-origin gas saying it was Omani/Iraqi, according to the US Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC)

↘ With Adani's purchases, US financial institutions processed payments of over $192 mn, representing a breach of the country's Iranian sanctions framework

The Closure
AEL will settle the case by paying $275 mn, which is significantly lower than the maximum possible fine of $384 mn. OFAC has closed the matter and released AEL from civil liability, without making any finding of fault or wrongdoings

criminal fraud charges against Gautam Adani, Sagar, Jaain and some executives of Azure Power, an Indian solar power producer that was then listed on the New York Stock Exchange. "We would like to inform you that the US DoJ filed a motion seeking dismissal with prejudice of the charges in the indictment against Mr Gautam S. Adani, Sagar R. Adani and Vneet S. Jaain and other defendants. The US DoJ further reviewed the charges and has decided in its prosecutorial discretion to dismiss the charges," Adani Green Energy said in a notice to the exchanges on May 18. The settlement comes after two years of efforts to prosecute with no findings.

FULL STEAM AHEAD

Adani Group shares surged on May 19 after news that the criminal fraud charges had been dismissed. While Adani Green Energy soared 3.5 per cent, Adani Total Gas rose 3.3 per cent, Adani Enterprises jumped over 3 per cent, and Adani Energy Solutions and Adani Power added 2.5 per cent each. Adani Ports was up 1 per cent.

In November 2024, the US District Court for the Eastern District of New York had accused Adani, Sagar, Jaain and the other executives of bribing Indian officials of electricity distribution companies (discoms) in four states and one Union territory (UT)—Andhra Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Tamil Nadu, Odisha and Jammu & Kashmir—to execute power sale agreements under a manufacturing-linked project with the public sector company, the Solar Energy Corporation of India (SECI) between 2021 and 2022. SECI would then buy the power from Adani and Azure Power to sell to the discoms. Of the $265 million (Rs 2,553 crore) alleged bribe, around $228 million (Rs 2,202 crore) was offered to an unnamed high-ranking Andhra Pradesh government official who facilitated the state discom's purchase of 7 gigawatts (7,000 MW) of power from SECI. With this, the accused violated the Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA) that bars companies operating in the US from bribing foreign officials, it was alleged. While this was a criminal charge, a parallel civil case by the SEC accused the Adani Group of raising billions of dollars in the